



EVIDENCE ROOM

Evidence Room — Product Overview

The AP Agent operating-system toolkit

Proof before permission.

Design the layer. Keep the stack. AP is the first domain.

Hard hold. ERP remains the system of record for accounting. Named humans remain the system of record for cash. Vendor-bank change and close attestation stay human. Duplicate & Anomaly flags are hypotheses, not fraud verdicts. This book is a method, not hosted software.

How to use this book

Buy Friday. Begin Monday. Do not charter from memory.

1. Score the free diagnostic (36 questions). Honour vetoes.
2. Map one path (usually PO-goods). Code exceptions from the closed list.
3. Charter Wave 1 at L0 or L1: Intake, Validation, Matching, Triage, Duplicate & Anomaly, Orchestrator.
4. Write the payment sentence on the wall. Agent 12 annotates; humans release.
5. Shadow before any write path. Promote only with an evidence pack.

Every page should answer at least one of: What should I do? How? Who owns it? What can go wrong? How do I control it? How do I measure it? What evidence proves it works?

Northline Industrials is a *fictional* manufacturer used so tables can be concrete (~15,000 invoices/month, Dynamics 365, Cleveland SSC). Figures are illustrative, not a client result.

Customer-facing statistics are limited to the research ledger. Do not paste vendor cost-per-invoice figures into a business case as targets.

Evidence Room — AP Agent OS

Lockup: EVIDENCE ROOM — AP AGENT OS
Domain: evidenceroom.ai
Brand idea: Proof before permission.
Category: Finance Agent Operating System for Accounts Payable
Version: 1.0.0 · 20 September 2026
Stance: Design the layer. Keep the stack.

This archive is a licensed digital method and toolkit. It is not an ERP, a payment service, an audit engagement, or hosted software. It does not authorise payments, detect fraud, certify compliance, guarantee accounting accuracy, or promise savings or ROI.

Northline Industrials appears throughout as a **fictional** mid-market manufacturer. Its figures are illustrative. They are not a benchmark and not a target.

What you have

Accounts Payable already has a stack: capture, match, workflow, ERP, bank. What it rarely has is an operating system for the agents now being dropped into that stack.

This suite specifies that layer: sixteen named roles, an evidence standard, a permission ladder (L0–L4), and a written list of decisions that stay human. Payment authorisation remains human at every autonomy level.

If you bought	You are licensed to use	You are not licensed to
Free Diagnostic	The readiness pack in 01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/	Treat the band as a certificate
Starter (\$79)	Free pack + 02_AP_AGENT_STARTER/	Share as a team working system; resell
Professional (\$199)	Starter contents + full 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/	Publish the library; treat files as software
Team (\$499)	Professional contents + 04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/ for a named working group	Redistribute outside the organisation
Custom Blueprint	A facilitated design against <i>your</i> stack; see 05_CUSTOM_BLUEPRINT/	Treat the application fee as a software licence

Licence instruments in 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/ control. This page is navigation, not the contract.

How the suite is organised

Folder	Job
00_READ_ME/	Start here. Index, version, Friday-to-Monday path, scale roadmap, refined master prompt.
01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/	36-question diagnostic, maturity model, ten-agent opportunity view, business-case starter language.
02_AP_AGENT_STARTER/	Operating model, top ten blueprints, implementation checklist, transformation roadmap.
03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/	Full OS: agent library, process mapping, governance, KPIs, testing, business-case model, templates.
04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/	Facilitation, workshop, trackers, training, enterprise governance.
05_CUSTOM_BLUEPRINT/	Application brochure, intake, fulfilment, pricing and scope.
06_SALES_AND_MARKETING/	Brand system and commercial language (internal / publisher use).
07_LEMON_SQUEEZY/	Store, fulfilment, and merchant-of-record notes (internal / publisher use).
09_RESEARCH/	Research ledger, competitors, ICP, claim standard, domain note, QA (publisher).
10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/	Disclaimer, licence, privacy, terms — drafts for counsel.

If a file and the Disclaimer conflict, the Disclaimer wins.

Friday-to-Monday path

A Controller, AP Manager, or Finance Transformation lead can do useful work in one weekend without commissioning a bot.

Friday afternoon (60–90 minutes)

1. Read this file and QUICK_START.md.
2. Complete the diagnostic in 01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/DIAGNOSTIC_GUIDE.md with last quarter's facts, not hopes.
3. Score 0–4 on each question. Do not average away a 0 on payment control.
4. Place the organisation on the L1–L5 maturity model. Write the band in one sentence.

Saturday (2–3 hours)

1. Open 02_AP_AGENT_STARTER/STARTER_GUIDE.md and the human-vs-agent one-pager.
2. Take the last ten exceptions and the last payment run. Classify each decision. Record where a vendor demo would have auto-released cash.
3. Charter Wave 1 only: Intake, Validation, Matching, Exception Triage, Duplicate & Anomaly, Orchestrator — at L0 or L1. Blank charters live in Starter; full specs live in Professional (03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Agent_Library/).
4. Write the payment sentence on the wall: **Agent 12 annotates. Humans release.**

Sunday (90 minutes)

1. Name one human owner and one backup for each Wave 1 agent. If you cannot name them, do not commission the agent.
2. Draft the first-week sampling plan: coverage, coded fail reasons, match worksheets, flag outcomes.

3. If you hold Professional or Team, skim 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Business_Case/NINETY_DAY_PLAN.md and put Phase 0 on a calendar. Do not build a savings slide.

Monday morning (45 minutes)

1. Circulate a one-page note: band, Wave 1 names, owners, payment hold, and the request for a 30-day control review with Internal Audit as observer.
2. Stand agents at L0 (shadow) if — and only if — owners, object types, and the evidence standard are written.
3. Refuse any proposal to “just turn on auto-post” or “just release under \$5k.”

That is a complete first cycle. Promotion is a later, evidence-gated decision. See 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Agent_Library/AUTONOMY_PROGRESSSION.md.

What “done” means in the first 30 days

Not a savings number. Not a fraud-catch count. Not a compliance certificate.

- Every inbound invoice in the pilot path has a work object.
- Validation fail reasons are coded.
- A defined sample of match worksheets can be reopened.
- Duplicate & Anomaly flags have a recorded human outcome (clear / confirm / escalate / defer).
- The autonomy register shows every live agent at L0 or L1.
- No payment left the organisation without the human release path your policy already requires.

If first-time match or cycle time later moves, treat that as an observed outcome. It is not why this toolkit exists.

Hard rules (read once, keep)

1. **Payment authorisation stays human.** There is no L3 or L4 path to release, transmit, or approve a payment run.
 2. **A flag is a hypothesis, not a verdict.** Do not write “fraud” on Agent 10 output.
 3. **ERP remains the system of record for accounting.** The Orchestrator is the system of record for work-object state.
 4. **The method is ERP-agnostic.** Map roles onto SAP, Oracle, Dynamics, NetSuite, Workday, or the stack you have. Do not invent a connector.
 5. **Northline is fiction.** Do not present its dollars or rates to a board as comparables.
 6. **Do not invent statistics.** Cite only sources named in the file you are using. If a number is illustrative, say so in the same sentence.
 7. **If it is not in the charter, the agent does not do it.**
 8. **Staffing gaps are queue problems, not autonomy arguments.**
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Brand collision (one paragraph)

A forensic-animation firm, Evidence Room LLC, operates at evidence-room.net. We are not that firm. Public lockup is always **EVIDENCE ROOM — AP AGENT OS**. Payment descriptors should include “AP

AGENT OS” or “EVIDENCEROOM.AI”, not only “EVIDENCE ROOM.” See 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/TRADEMARK_AND_DOMAIN_NOTES.md. This note is hygiene, not a legal opinion.

Where to go next

Need	Open
Twelve numbered steps	QUICK_START.md
Every file in the archive	PRODUCT_INDEX.md
What changed in this edition	VERSION_HISTORY.md
The specification used to build the suite	REFINED_MASTER_PROMPT.md
Score the organisation	01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/
Begin Wave 1 on one desk	02_AP_AGENT_STARTER/
Full sixteen-agent OS	03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/
Run a team workshop	04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/
Commission a facilitated design	05_CUSTOM_BLUEPRINT/

Document control

Field	Value
Toolkit	Evidence Room — AP Agent OS
Object	Suite navigation
Status	Working edition 1.0.0
Related	All folders in this archive
Not	Legal advice, implementation consulting, or a hosted product

START HERE — 12 steps

Product: Evidence Room — AP Agent OS

Time: One working day if you already know last quarter's volumes; two if you must gather facts.

Output: A named Wave 1, named owners, a payment sentence, and a shadow-mode plan.

Not an output: A savings target, a fraud programme, a compliance certificate, or permission to pay.

Do these in order. Skipping to a favourite agent is how undocumented workforces get built.

Before step 1

Confirm which licence you hold. Use only the folders you are licensed to use. If you have the Free Diagnostic only, stop after step 4 and use the starter language in 01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/BUSINESS_CASE_STARTER.md to decide whether to licence Starter or Professional.

Have at hand: last-quarter invoice volume, exception mix (even if messy), the last payment-run procedure, the names of the AP Manager, Controls Lead, and whoever signs the payment file.

Do not upload production invoices, vendor bank details, or employee records to Evidence Room. This toolkit does not need them.

Step 1 — Read the contract of the product (15 minutes)

Read 00_READ_ME/README.md and the short disclaimer in 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/DISCLAIMER.md (or the on-page short form if you only have a commercial pack).

Write this sentence at the top of your working note:

We are designing an agent layer across the AP stack we already run. Payment authorisation stays human. Proof before permission.

If a sponsor wants that sentence rewritten into a guarantee, stop. This product will not write the guarantee.

Step 2 — Diagnose the layer you have (45–60 minutes)

Open 01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/DIAGNOSTIC_GUIDE.md.

Answer all 36 questions across six dimensions: process, data, controls, technology, talent, economics. Score each 0–4 using the rubric in that file. Use evidence you can reopen (a report, a SOP, a ticket), not recollection.

Compute dimension averages. Do **not** let a high technology score cancel a 0 on payment control or vendor-bank dual control.

Place the organisation on the L1–L5 maturity model in 01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/MATURITY_MODEL.md.

Step 3 — Write the one-sentence band (10 minutes)

Use this form. Fill the blanks. Do not add a savings clause.

We are at **L[n] — [name]**. Agents are **[absent / informal prompts / named but ungated / chartered at L0–L1 / evidence-gated]**. Payment release is **[written as human / assumed / unclear]**. First wave is **[six names]** at **L0/L1**.

Northline's fictional Friday sentence: *We are at L2 — Informal Activity. Agents are informal prompts in capture and a matching copilot. Payment release is written as human. First wave is Intake, Validation, Matching, Triage, Duplicate & Anomaly, Orchestrator at L0/L1.*

Step 4 — Name the human holds (20 minutes)

Copy the human-held list from 02_AP_AGENT_STARTER/STARTER_GUIDE.md (or Professional: 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Agent_Library/HUMAN_VS_AGENT_DECISION_FRAMEWORK.md).

Tick each item that is already true in your policy **and** in the system. A policy that says dual approval while a demo script auto-releases is not a hold. It is a gap.

Minimum holds that must be true before any agent is live:

1. Payment authorisation and bank-file transmission — human.
2. Vendor bank-detail create or change — human dual control.
3. New vendor approval — human.
4. DOA and tolerance-table edits — human.
5. Period-end attestation — human.
6. Clearing a high-value duplicate or anomaly flag — named control owner.

If any of 1–3 is false, Wave 1 is still allowed at L0 only, and Agent 12 is not opened.

Step 5 — Classify ten exceptions and one payment run (70 minutes)

Print or export:

- the ten most recent parked or rejected invoices
- the last payment proposal (or equivalent)

For each line write: decision class (cash / master data / reversible accounting / documentary / routing / external commitment / judgement / investigation signal / attestation / design change), modifiers (value, new vendor, open flag, tax, multi-entity), who decided, and what an agent would have been allowed to do at L1.

Record, in one column, what a vendor demo would have auto-done. Those cells are the control conversation, not a shopping list.

Starter has a table for this. Professional has the full framework and worked Northline examples.

Step 6 — Charter Wave 1 only (90 minutes)

Charter six agents, no more:

ID	Agent	Default level	Typical owner
01	Invoice Intake	L1 (or L0 if extract quality is unknown)	AP Operations Lead
02	Invoice Validation	L1	AP Quality Lead
03	Matching	L1	AP Match Lead
04	Exception Triage	L1	Exception Desk Lead
10	Duplicate & Anomaly	L0	AP Controls Lead
16	Orchestrator	L1	AP Process Owner

Use the charter template in Starter or 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Agent_Library/AGENT_CHARTER_TEMPLATE.md. For each agent name: object types, entities, evidence required, exclusions, failure detection, rollback.

Do not charter Agents 12 or 13 above L1. Do not discuss L3.

If you cannot name a human owner, leave the agent unchartered.

Step 7 — Freeze the evidence standard (20 minutes)

A recommendation is eligible for a human decision only when the packet contains:

- source (image, XML, EDI, or portal artefact)
- extract or equivalent structured fields
- match worksheet or coded fail reason
- owner and SLA clock
- autonomy context
- flag outcome if Agent 10 fired
- link the Orchestrator can reopen

Incomplete packets do not travel. Perfect packets still do not pay.

Write this list into the Orchestrator charter. That is the product mechanic for **proof before permission**.

Step 8 — Stand a two-week L0 window (15 minutes to schedule; two weeks to run)

Shadow only. Output is not the system of record. Operators work as they do today. The agent writes a parallel record.

Minimum L0 evidence before anyone talks about L1 as the system of record:

- coverage on the in-scope path
- required fields present
- a dual-review sample of disagreements
- zero silent scope expansion
- a cost ledger started (licence + model + exception minutes), even if the numbers are small
- language check: no fraud, compliance, accuracy-as-property, or savings claims in agent output

Gates are in Professional: AUTONOMY_PROGRESSION.md. Starter users: stay at shadow until those gates are written down locally.

Step 9 — Put cost and quality on one page (30 minutes)

Do not build an ROI slide.

Open 01_FREE_AP_AI_READINESS/BUSINESS_CASE_STARTER.md and, if licensed, 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Business_Case/COST_PER_INVOICE_MODEL.md.

Record:

- invoices per month (your number)
- fully loaded AP cost you already use internally
- exception rate you can defend
- current cost-per-invoice **range** if you have one; otherwise leave blank
- estimated layer cost (tools + implementation + model) as a **budget**, not a payback

Industry figures, when used, must be labelled as vendor-originated citations of independent research. See the business-case files. Do not invent a midpoint and call it yours.

Step 10 — Schedule governance before go-live (20 minutes)

Book four meetings now:

When	Meeting	Purpose
Week 0	Kickoff with AP, Controls, Transformation	Confirm Wave 1, owners, payment sentence
Weekly	Exception mix (30 minutes)	Codes, aging by owner, language slips
Day 30	Control review	Internal Audit observes packets; no operator role
Day 90	Recertify or demote	Autonomy register; retire what is expensive and wrong

Team licence holders: use 04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/STEERING_COMMITTEE_TEMPLATES.md.

Step 11 — Write the Monday note (20 minutes)

Send one page. Suggested subject: *AP agent layer — Wave 1 at observe/recommend*.

Include: maturity band, six agent names, six owners, the payment sentence, the two-week shadow plan, the 30-day review, and one refusal (“we will not auto-release payments”).

Do not include a savings range. Do not include a fraud-detection claim. Do not include Northline’s numbers as if they were yours.

Executive templates: 04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/EXECUTIVE_COMMUNICATION_TEMPLATES.md (Team) or the short form in 03_AP_AGENT_OS_PRO/Business_Case/BOARD_CFO_SUMMARY.md (Professional).

Step 12 — Stop conditions (read every week)

Stop commissioning, and demote or pause, if any of these is true:

- A payment was released on an agent recommendation without the human path.
- Vendor bank details were changed from an agent pack without dual control.
- Agent 10 output used the word “fraud” in an operator-facing ticket.
- An agent processed object types outside its charter.

- Owners are vacant and someone “just kept it running.”
- A vendor or integrator proposed skipping evidence gates to hit a date.

Stopping is a successful control outcome.

After the 12 steps

If this is true	Do this
Diagnostic only	Decide whether Starter or Professional is the next licence
Starter, Wave 1 named	Run the two-week shadow; buy Professional before promoting
Professional	Open the sixteen specs; stay on Wave 1 until gates pass
Team	Run the workshop in 04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/WORKSHOP_AGENDA.md
Stack is unusual or political	Apply for Custom Blueprint (05_CUSTOM_BLUEPRINT/)

Document control

Field	Value
Toolkit	Evidence Room — AP Agent OS
Object	12-step START HERE
Companion	README.md, diagnostic, Starter guide
Status	Edition 1.0.0

Scale Roadmap — Evidence Room — AP Agent OS

Lockup: EVIDENCE ROOM — AP AGENT OS

Date: 20 September 2026

Status: Publisher strategy. Not a customer promise, not a valuation model, not a build ticket.

Rule: First make AP exceptional. Future finance modules are named so we do not pretend they do not exist. **Do not build them.**

1. Destination, in one line

A licensed AP digital product, then a thin services layer, then a recurring subscription around the same OS, then — only if AP is genuinely exceptional — an Evidence Room **Finance Agent** platform. The platform is a later company. It is not this edition.

2. Why this order

McKinsey's independent 2025 research (see 09_RESEARCH/RESEARCH_LEDGER.md) describes wide AI use, thin scaling, and workflow redesign as a high-performer differentiator. That is **context**, not a warrant to sprawl into AR, treasury, and FP&A before Accounts Payable has a complete, governed, teachable operating system.

Sprawl is how unofficial permission returns: a new module, a new copilot, no packet.

The brand idea — **proof before permission** — applies to the company as well as to agents. The company does not receive permission to become a platform until the AP product has produced evidence: repeatable fulfilment, clean claims, named users who finished Wave 1, and a support load we can stand.

3. The path (four stages)

AP digital product → services → recurring subscription → Finance Agent platform
 ↑
 └ stay here until AP is exceptional

Stage	What we sell	What we do not sell yet	Exit evidence (permission to proceed)
S1 — AP digital product	Diagnostic \$0; Starter \$79; Professional \$199; Team \$499	Hosted agents, ERP connectors, AR/Close/Treasury modules	Fulfilment works. Claims stay inside the ledger. Buyers finish Friday-to-Monday. Refunds and support are survivable.
S2 — Services	Custom Blueprint \$1,500–\$3,000; optional office hours; Team workshops as facilitation of the same OS	A general AI-in-finance consultancy; implementation of SAP	Blueprint hours are priced and capped. Deliverables are charters and registers, not unpaid software. No savings guarantees enter the SOW.
S3 — Recurring subscription	Annual update window, office-hours pool, shared licence refresh, later a member library — still files and facilitation , not a runtime	A SaaS that posts invoices	Demand is real (repeat Professional/Team, asked-for updates). Lemon Squeezy subscription extra (+0.5%) and product confusion are accepted knowingly . Counsel refreshes licence language.
S4 — Evidence Room Finance Agent platform	A later hosted control plane for work objects, autonomy registers, and evidence URIs across the buyer's stack	A new ERP	Only after S1 is exceptional. Separate product decision. Separate security, privacy, and payment-boundary engineering. Not this year of work.

S1 is the current company. S2 is already sketched (05_CUSTOM_BLUEPRINT/). S3 and S4 are **gated**. Skipping a gate is a brand defect.

4. Stage 1 — Make AP exceptional (current work)

4.1 What “exceptional” means (no savings number)

AP Agent OS is exceptional when **all** of the following are true:

1. **Complete method.** Sixteen agents, L0–L4, human-vs-agent table, exception atlas, governance cadence, testing path, Friday-to-Monday journey — internally consistent.
2. **Honest commercial surface.** Site, store, and emails say we do not replace the stack and do not promise ROI, fraud detection, compliance, or payment safety.
3. **Evidence discipline.** Every external figure traces to 09_RESEARCH/RESEARCH_LEDGER.md.
4. **Fulfilment.** A buyer can download, open START HERE, and do useful work without a call.
5. **Support load.** hello@ answers fulfilment and licence questions. Professional does not secretly become consulting.
6. **Legal hygiene.** Counsel has seen licence, privacy, refund, and the Evidence Room LLC collision. Domain is registered.
7. **Designed artefacts exist** for the things we already specified in Markdown: diagnostic worksheet, steering slides, scorecard workbook, website. Until those exist, “exceptional” is **authoring-complete**, not **go-to-market-complete**.

4.2 What we build in S1

- The licensed zip (folders 00–05 as sold).
- Publisher packs 06, 07, 09, 10.
- Lemon Squeezy store for one-time SKUs. **No LS subscription SKU at launch** (avoids +0.5% and SaaS confusion).
- evidenceroom.ai (or apagentos.com fallback — 09_RESEARCH/DOMAIN_AND_TRADEMARK_NOTE.md).

4.3 What we refuse in S1

- Hosted invoice processing.
- ERP connectors.
- An “autonomous payment” feature.
- Marketplace prompt-pack positioning.
- New finance domains (see §6).

5. Stage 2 — Services (only as a productised overlay)

Services exist to **apply** the OS, not to invent a second method.

Offer	Job	Hard edge
Custom Blueprint	Facilitate <i>their</i> layer on <i>their</i> stack	Application, quoted \$1,500–\$3,000. Not an instant custom PDF.
Office hours (optional later)	Unblock START HERE	Time-boxed. No live payment-file review.
Team workshop	One-day working session from the Team pack	Uses 04_AP_AGENT_OS_TEAM/. Not a transformation programme.

Economics reminder (from the publisher model, not a customer ROI): a Blueprint sold at the low end that consumes many long sessions can have worse labour economics than several Professional licences. Track hours. Do not let S2 eat S1.

Do not staff a delivery factory for SAP implementations. That is someone else's company.

6. Stage 3 — Recurring subscription (later, conscious)

Recurring is for **continuity of the method**, not for a runtime:

- 12-month update entitlement becoming a true annual membership
- New agent-charter examples, exception codes, and recertification packs
- Scheduled office hours
- Team-seat true-up

Launch today is a **licence**, not SaaS. Turning on Lemon Squeezy subscriptions adds fee drag and implies hosting we do not operate. Do it only with a written product decision, updated Terms, and a page that still says: files and method, not a login that posts invoices.

7. Stage 4 — Evidence Room Finance Agent platform (do not build)

A future platform would be a **control plane**: work-object IDs, evidence URIs, autonomy register, SLA clocks — sitting **across** ERP and suites. It would still not be the system of record for accounting or cash.

It would require: security review, data-processing terms, tenant isolation, and a re-statement of the payment ceiling in software, not only in Markdown.

Permission is withheld. There is no prototype ticket in this edition.

8. Future modules — named so we can refuse them

These are **possible later domains** for the same operating-system idea. They are not a roadmap we will staff.

Module	Why people will ask	Why we will not build it now
AR	Symmetric “agentic” story; Order-to-Cash vendors already exist	Different objects, different fraud story, different cash application politics. Dilutes AP excellence.
Close	Agent 13 already touches AP close	Full record-to-report is a Controller product, not an AP add-on tab.
Treasury	Agent 12 already annotates payment proposals	Treasury agents that “optimise cash” collapse into payment authority. Hard no until AP payment holds are boringly true in the field.
Reconciliation	Agent 11 is a wedge	Subledger-to-GL and bank rec are their own control environments.
Controls	We already produce evidence	A GRC platform is a different category. We produce packets; we do not declare controls sufficient.
FP&A	McKinsey's finance-AI article spends time here	Forecast agents are a different buyer and a different error cost. Not AP.

DO NOT BUILD these modules. Do not open folder 11_AR_AGENT_OS. Do not sell an “Evidence Room Suite” SKU. Do not staff prompt packs for cash application “while we are at it.”

If a Blueprint applicant asks for AR or treasury, the answer is: **we make AP exceptional first**. Decline or stay inside AP Agent 01–16.

9. What may be reused later (without building modules)

When — if — a later edition opens another domain, it may reuse:

- Autonomy ladder L0–L4
- Proof-before-permission gates
- Human-vs-agent decision classes
- Orchestrator as work-object system of record
- Evidence standard and research ledger discipline
- “Design the layer. Keep the stack.”

It may not reuse AP exception codes, Agent 12’s payment ceiling language as if it applied to collections, or Northline’s payables volumes as an AR TAM.

Reuse of the **method** is allowed in the mind. Reuse of the **SKU** is a new product decision.

10. Publisher sequence (practical)

Now	Next (still AP)	Not yet
Finish and ship the AP zip	Designed PDFs, Excel scorecard, PPTX steering pack, website HTML	AR / Close / Treasury / Rec / Controls / FP&A products
Register evidenceroom.ai	Counsel on mark + LLC	Hosted platform
Lemon Squeezy one-time SKUs	Blueprint fulfilment discipline	LS subscription SKU
Ledger-true marketing	Measured (not promised) buyer feedback	Savings calculator as a public toy

09_RESEARCH/QA_SCORECARD.md lists the artefact gap. Closing that gap is S1 work. It is not permission to start S4.

11. Kill criteria (demote the company plan)

Stop advancing a stage — or retire a draft module — if:

- Copy drifts into ROI, fraud, or touchless promises.
- Blueprint becomes unpaid software implementation.
- A “platform” spike starts before AP fulfilment is boring.
- Counsel flags the master brand and we refuse to rename.
- Anyone staffs AR because a competitor slide mentioned it.

Stopping is a successful control outcome. The OS says the same to agents.

Document control

Field	Value
Toolkit	Evidence Room — AP Agent OS
Object	Scale roadmap
Related	09_RESEARCH/ , 07_LEMON_SQUEEZY/FINANCIAL_MODEL.md
Status	Strategy as of 20 September 2026
Not	A public launch promise or an engineering backlog

Product Copy — EVIDENCE ROOM — AP AGENT OS

Use: Site modules, storefront, sales conversations, PDF covers, in-product START HERE.

Voice: Intelligent, concise, credible, executive, specific, non-hype.

Brand idea: Proof before permission.

Related: BRAND_SYSTEM.md, LANDING_PAGE_COPY.md, WEBSITE_IA_AND_COPY.md, 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/.

This file is commercial copy. It is not legal advice. Licence, refund, privacy, and disclaimer language must be confirmed by qualified counsel before publish.

Headline

Proof before permission.

The operating system for building, governing, and scaling AI agents across Accounts Payable.

Subhead

Evidence Room — AP Agent OS does not replace the AP stack you already run. It is the method and toolkit for designing the agent layer that operates across it: sixteen named roles, an evidence standard, a permission ladder, and a written list of decisions that stay human.

Value proposition

Finance and transformation leaders are being asked to put AI on invoice-to-pay. Most will do it by pasting prompts into the nearest tool. That produces activity without a workforce model, without evidence gates, and without a payment boundary.

AP Agent OS is the operating system for that layer. You specify each agent, name its human owner, define the packet it must produce, and withhold the next unit of permission until the evidence exists. ERP remains the system of record for accounting. Named humans remain the system of record for payment, vendor bank details, and close attestation.

You keep Coupa, SAP, Oracle, Dynamics, NetSuite, Tipalti, BILL, the shared-service team, and the delegation of authority. You add a designed layer, not another platform to implement.

Features

Each feature is an artefact the buyer can open. None is a hosted robot.

1. Sixteen-agent architecture

A named portfolio, not a blob called “AP AI.”

Invoice Intake. Invoice Validation. Matching. Exception Triage. Goods Receipt. PO Quality. Approval. Supplier Resolution. Internal Follow-up. Duplicate & Anomaly. Vendor Statement. Payment Proposal Review. AP Close. AP Reporting. Root Cause. Orchestrator.

Every agent has a job, a default autonomy, a typical human owner, a list of exclusions, and a place in the invoice lifecycle. Intake does not decide match. Matching does not invent receipts. Triage does not resolve. Payment Proposal Review annotates; it does not release.

2. Evidence standard

A written definition of what must sit in the packet before a recommendation is eligible for a human decision: source, extract, match worksheet, correspondence, approval log, flag outcome, owner, SLA clock. Incomplete packets do not travel. Perfect packets still do not pay.

3. Permission ladder (L0–L4)

- **L0 Observe** — read, classify, log, shadow-report. No reliance.
- **L1 Recommend** — propose with rationale and evidence. No ERP write. No external send.
- **L2 Prepare** — assemble a complete ready-to-act packet. A human or downstream control executes.
- **L3 Execute within guardrails** — only a named, pre-approved, low-risk action inside a written limit table.
- **L4 Managed autonomy** — the same bounded set as L3, reviewed by exception and recertified.

Default for a new agent is L0 or L1. No agent is commissioned at L3 or L4. Payment-related work has a hard ceiling: recommend and prepare only.

4. Human-vs-agent decision framework

A one-page rights table for the decisions that never leave the control environment: payment authorisation and release, vendor bank-detail change, new vendor approval, DOA edits, tolerance-table edits, period-end attestation, material write-off, ambiguous tax, legal settlement language, high-value anomaly clearance, override of a policy hold, and expansion of an agent's own scope.

5. Agent charter template

A blank charter plus a completed Matching Agent example. Monday work: name the owner, the object types, the evidence, the exclusions, and the starting level.

6. Exception atlas

Coded break types so fail reasons are analysable. Free-text-only exceptions are treated as a design smell, not a culture.

7. Orchestrator model

Every invoice, exception, statement line, and payment-proposal line is a work object with an ID, source, current agent, human owner, status, autonomy context, evidence URI, SLA clock, escalation state, and cost token. The Orchestrator is the system of record for work-object state. The ERP remains the system of record for accounting.

8. KPI language that refuses theatre

Operating-discipline measures: capture completeness, coded validation fails, sampled match worksheets, recorded flag outcomes, aging by named owner, dual-human payment release, an autonomy register with no silent promotions, and cost per thousand invoices (licence + model + exception minutes). Not a savings guarantee. Not an ROI calculator.

9. Governance cadence

Weekly exception mix. Monthly policy and limit-table review. Quarterly autonomy recertification. Internal Audit as observer, not operator. Model and prompt changes treated as change-controlled configuration.

10. 90-day layer plan

Wave 1: six agents at L0/L1 (Intake, Validation, Matching, Triage, Duplicate & Anomaly, Orchestrator).
Wave 2: prepare-level packets. Wave 3: periodic agents. Wave 4: earned execute for a narrow clean-match class only after gates — still never payment release.

11. Readiness diagnostic

A structured assessment of whether the organisation has an agent layer, a pile of prompts, or neither. Produces a picture and a recommended first wave. Does not certify readiness, compliance, or investment return.

12. Fictional operating picture

Northline Industrials — a made-up mid-market manufacturer — is used throughout the library so the charters are concrete. Figures are illustrative. They are not a benchmark and not a promise.

Outcomes (what improves — stated as operating discipline)

Use these sentences. Do not upgrade them into guarantees.

- **Named workforce.** The organisation can point to sixteen roles instead of “the AP copilot.”
- **Inspectable packets.** A Controller or auditor can open the evidence for a sampled invoice, exception, or proposal line.
- **Withheld permission.** Autonomy is visible on a register. Promotion is a decision. Demotion is available.
- **Held payment boundary.** Two humans still release the run. The method writes that down so a vendor cannot shrug it off.
- **Coded exceptions.** Mix becomes analysable. Root Cause has something to cluster.
- **Visible layer cost.** Licence, model, and exception minutes are recorded per thousand invoices.
- **Shared language.** AP, Controls, Transformation, Treasury, and Audit can disagree on a charter instead of on a vibe.
- **No rip-and-replace.** The stack stays. The layer is designed.

If first-time match or cycle time later moves, treat that as an observed outcome after commissioning — not as a reason anyone bought.

Frequently asked questions

Is this software that connects to our ERP?

No. AP Agent OS is a licensed digital toolkit and method. You implement with the ERP, capture, workflow, RPA, iPaaS, and human procedures you already have or will choose. The architecture is ERP-agnostic.

Does this replace our AP platform?

No. Design the layer. Keep the stack. Capture, match, workflow, and payment tools remain. The OS specifies how agents should work across them.

Will this make payments autonomous?

No. Payment authorisation and release stay human at every autonomy level. Agent 12 (Payment Proposal Review) may annotate a proposal. It may not approve, release, or transmit payment. If a vendor proposes that an agent “just release the run if everything looks fine,” the method's answer is no.

Does the Duplicate & Anomaly agent detect fraud?

No. It raises flags — hypotheses — for human review. A flag is not a verdict, not a fraud finding, and not authorisation to hold or release funds on its own. Clearing a high-value flag is a named human control.

Does using this make us compliant?

No. The toolkit produces evidence a control owner can present. The control owner decides sufficiency. Evidence Room does not provide legal, audit, tax, or regulatory advice and does not certify compliance with any standard.

Does this guarantee savings or ROI?

No. We do not promise savings, cost-takeout, cycle-time reduction, or return on investment. We give you language and measures for operating discipline. Any later cost discussion is a management judgement.

Is this just a prompt pack?

No. A prompt is an instruction to a model. An operating system is a set of roles, rights, evidence, refusals, owners, and promotion gates. Professional includes example instruction patterns where they help a charter; they are not the product.

Who is the buyer?

The practitioner who will design the layer — typically a Finance Transformation lead, AP Manager, Controller, or a small trio of those roles — and the organisation that will licence Team or commission a Custom Blueprint.

What do I actually download?

A structured file set: architecture, agent specifications, charter template, decision framework, autonomy progression, KPI and governance language, diagnostic, 90-day path, and a START HERE sequence. Formats are documents and worksheets, not a hosted app.

Can I share it with my team?

Individual and Professional licences are for one practitioner and ordinary internal working use within the named organisation, as described in the licence. Team is the licence designed for a shared AP / Controls / Transformation / Audit working group. None of the licences permit resale, redistribution, or publishing the materials as your own product. Confirm the final licence with counsel before relying on this summary.

Do you store our invoice data?

The diagnostic and the toolkit, as sold, do not require you to upload invoice files or ERP extracts to Evidence Room. If you paste examples into a form, treat that as your disclosure. See Privacy and the AI-use disclosure.

What if we are already running agents?

Start with the diagnostic and the autonomy register. Most early programmes have activity without charters, without evidence gates, and with unclear payment holds. The OS is for that situation as much as for a green field.

Is Northline a customer?

No. Northline Industrials is a fictional company used to make the library concrete.

Which countries and ERPs?

The method is written in plain finance English and mapped to common invoice-to-pay objects. It is not localised legal advice for any jurisdiction and not a certified adapter for any ERP.

Objection handling**“We already have Copilot / an IDP vendor / a bot in AP.”**

Keep it. The question is whether you have a workforce model, an evidence standard, a permission ladder, and a human-held payment boundary — or a feature turned on in one screen. The OS sits across tools. It does not ask you to turn them off.

“We don’t need another framework.”

You need named roles and named refusals before the first model call that touches a payment proposal. A framework that withholds permission is cheaper than an undocumented agent that everyone assumes is “just helping.”

“Our volume is small.”

Then you can read the whole Professional toolkit in a sitting and still use the decision framework on ten exceptions and one payment run. Small volume is not a reason to skip the payment hold.

“Our volume is huge; we need software.”

You still need the layer designed before you scale L1 recommendations across 80,000 invoices. Software without charters scales ambiguity. Buy or build software; specify here first.

“Legal / InfoSec will never allow agents.”

Good. Give them the human-vs-agent table and the exclusions list. Many blocks exist because the proposal was “autonomous AP.” A proposal that starts at L0, names owners, and forbids payment release is a different conversation.

“Internal Audit will slow this down.”

Invite them as observers at day 30. The product assumes they will sample packets. That is a feature.

“This feels like consulting.”

Consulting is a facilitated judgement on *your* stack. Professional is a licensed toolkit you apply. Custom Blueprint is the facilitated option, by application, at a stated range. Do not blur them.

“\$199 / \$499 seems expensive for documents.”

You are licensing an operating system for a workforce that will sit next to cash. The alternative in the market is a prompt list or a slide. Compare it to a week of undocumented agent experiments, not to a PDF page count.

“Can we try it on one invoice type?”

Yes. Wave 1 is six agents at observe/recommend. Charter Matching on one clean PO class before you discuss anything else.

“We need guaranteed outcomes to get budget.”

Then this is the wrong product to put in that business case. We will not write the guarantee. If budget requires a savings number, that number must come from the organisation's own baseline and judgement — not from our copy.

“Isn't 'Evidence Room' that courtroom animation company?”

Different organisation. Evidence Room LLC is a forensic-animation firm at evidence-room.net. We are EVIDENCE ROOM — AP AGENT OS at evidenceroom.ai. We do not do courtroom reconstruction. Trademark clearance remains an open professional item.

Purchase rationale (for the buyer to paste internally)

Subject: Licence — Evidence Room AP Agent OS

We are being asked to introduce AI agents into Accounts Payable. We have (or will have) tools. We do not have a written operating system for the agent layer: named roles, evidence required before a recommendation is eligible, autonomy levels, and a hard human hold on payment release.

Evidence Room — AP Agent OS is a licensed digital toolkit for that layer. It does not replace our ERP or AP platform. It does not authorise payments. It does not claim fraud detection, compliance, accounting accuracy, or ROI.

I recommend [Professional / Team / Custom Blueprint] so that Transformation, AP, Controls, and Audit work from one architecture before any agent is allowed to recommend in the system of record. First use: complete the diagnostic, charter Wave 1 (Intake, Validation, Matching, Triage, Duplicate & Anomaly, Orchestrator) at L0/L1, and run the human-vs-agent framework on ten recent exceptions and one payment run.

Versus prompt packs

	Prompt pack	AP Agent OS
Unit of design	A paragraph the model sees	A named agent with owner, objects, evidence, exclusions
Permission	Implied by whoever pasted the prompt	Withheld until evidence gates are met
Payment	Often unmentioned	Explicitly outside agent authority
Exceptions	Free text	Coded atlas and triage rights
Fraud language	Often “detect fraud”	Flags as hypotheses; human clearance
System of record	The chat window	ERP for accounting; Orchestrator for work objects
Promotion	Someone turns the temperature up	Written L0–L4 gates; recertification
Sharing	Slack the prompt	Licensed artefacts a team can argue about
Failure mode	Confident action with no packet	Incomplete packet does not travel
What you buy	Instructions	An operating system for a workforce

A prompt can live *inside* a charter. It cannot replace one.

Licence explanation (plain language — counsel must confirm)

This is a summary of commercial intent, not the legal instrument. The instrument lives in `10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/LICENCE_TERMS.md`.

Individual (Starter, \$79)

One named practitioner. Personal working use. May apply the method inside their employer’s AP programme. May not publish the files, resell them, sublicense them, or include them in a client deliverable as if they were the practitioner’s original product.

Professional (\$199)

One named practitioner. Full toolkit. Same use pattern as Individual, with the complete library, autonomy progression, KPI language, and 90-day path. Ordinary internal presentation to colleagues is expected. Posting the library on a public drive, a marketplace, or a client portal is not.

Team (\$499)

A named organisation and a working group (suggested cap in the legal draft: up to 10 named practitioners — confirm). Shared charters, shared autonomy register, shared diagnostic. Still no resale, no redistribution outside the organisation, no sublicensing, no publishing as the organisation’s product for sale.

Custom Blueprint (\$1,500–\$3,000 application)

A facilitated design engagement using the OS against the applicant’s stack. Deliverables and licence for those deliverables are scoped in the application acceptance. The core toolkit licence still forbids resale of Evidence Room materials.

All licences — refused uses

- Resale or redistribution of the files
- Sublicensing
- Publishing the toolkit, or a thin rewrite of it, as your own product

- Using Evidence Room name or lockup to imply partnership, certification, or endorsement
- Representing the toolkit as software that processes live payments

Disclaimers (on-page short form)

Use this block at the foot of product, pricing, and checkout pages. Long form: 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/DISCLAIMER.md.

Evidence Room — AP Agent OS is a digital method and toolkit for designing and governing an Accounts Payable agent layer. It is not an ERP, payment service, audit, legal, tax, or compliance service. It does not detect fraud, authorise payments, guarantee accounting accuracy, guarantee savings or ROI, or make an organisation compliant with any law or standard. Implementation decisions, including whether and how to use AI models, remain yours. Northline Industrials is a fictional example. Trademark and domain matters are described in our legal notes and remain subject to professional clearance.

Refund language recommendation (not a policy until counsel and MoR confirm)

Commercial recommendation to take to a lawyer and to Lemon Squeezy settings:

- **Window:** 14 days from purchase for Starter, Professional, and Team.
- **Standard:** Refund if the buyer has not been able to access the files through no fault of their own, or if the files are materially not as described (missing advertised modules).
- **Digital-use clause:** If the buyer has downloaded the full archive and had a reasonable opportunity to inspect it, refunds are discretionary, except where Lemon Squeezy as merchant of record or applicable consumer law requires otherwise.
- **Custom Blueprint:** Application fee / engagement fee is scoped in the acceptance note. Recommend: refundable if Evidence Room declines the application before work starts; not refundable after kickoff for completed time, subject to law.
- **Free Diagnostic:** No payment. No refund mechanic.
- **Chargebacks:** Respond with delivery logs and the licence page the buyer accepted.
- **Do not** advertise “100% money-back guarantee if you don’t save money.” That reintroduces a banned ROI frame.

Publish only the version counsel and the merchant-of-record settings agree. See 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/REFUND_POLICY.md and 07_LEMON_SQUEEZY/CHECKOUT_AND_EMAILS.md.

Delivery

Item	What happens
Free Diagnostic	Immediate on-site or emailed worksheet + scoring guide. No licence key required.
Starter / Professional / Team	Lemon Squeezy issues a licence key and a signed download link after payment. Fulfilment email points to START HERE.
Custom Blueprint	Application form. Human review. If accepted, scoped kickoff and a private working space. Not an instant download of a "custom" pack.
Formats	Markdown / PDF / worksheets as packaged. No installer. No ERP connector.
Access period	Download links follow Lemon Squeezy's signed-link behaviour (throttled, expiring). Buyers should archive their licensed copy. Confirm current LS behaviour at launch.
Support	Email support for fulfilment and licence issues: hello@evidenceroom.ai. No promise of implementation consulting inside Professional.
Updates	Professional and Team include specified toolkit updates for 12 months from purchase, if and when published. Not a software SLA. Confirm in Terms.

Privacy (buyer-facing short form)

We sell a downloadable toolkit. We do not need your invoice images, vendor master, or payment files to deliver it.

We process the personal data required to take an order (name, email, organisation, payment metadata via Lemon Squeezy), to send the diagnostic or fulfilment email, and to answer support mail.

Do not upload production invoice files, bank details, or employee records to our forms. If you choose to paste an anonymised example, you are responsible for what you paste.

Lemon Squeezy acts as merchant of record for paid checkout and processes payment data on that path. See 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/PRIVACY.md. Confirm with counsel and with Lemon Squeezy's current DPA position before publish.

AI-use disclosure (buyer-facing)

Evidence Room uses AI tools in the research and drafting of some toolkit language and commercial copy. A human editor is responsible for the published method.

The toolkit is designed so that *your* organisation may later use AI models as the engine inside a chartered agent. That use is yours. We do not run those models on your invoices as part of a Professional purchase.

The method forbids presenting model output as a fraud finding, a compliance certificate, a payment authorisation, or an accounting fact without a named human and an evidence pack.

Full text: 10_LEGAL_AND_LICENSING/AI_USE_DISCLOSURE.md.

Implementation limitations (say these before the sale)

1. **You still have to do the work.** Charters, owners, sampling, and recertification are organisational habits. Files do not install them.
2. **You still need a stack.** The OS does not capture invoices, post documents, or send bank files.

3. **Models fail.** Extraction will be wrong sometimes. Matching will be wrong sometimes. The method assumes error and designs holds, not perfection.
 4. **L3 is rare and narrow.** If your political goal is “touchless AP this quarter,” this product will disappoint you on purpose.
 5. **Local law and policy win.** DOA, tax, employment, and payment rules in your entities override any template.
 6. **No connector certification.** Mapping to SAP, Oracle, Dynamics, NetSuite, or Workday is a design activity, not a supported integration.
 7. **Northline is fiction.** Do not present its figures to a board as comparables.
 8. **One practitioner cannot silently bind a group.** If AP, Controls, and Audit must share, buy Team.
 9. **Affiliates and partners cannot resell the files.** They can refer a checkout link if an affiliate programme exists.
 10. **We will not write your savings slide.** If that is the only artefact your PMO wants, do not buy this.
-

Closing line (product)

Keep the stack. Design the layer. Withhold permission until the packet exists.

Proof before permission.

Disclaimer — Draft for Counsel

Status: Working draft. **Not legal advice.** Intended for /disclaimer, checkout footers, and the zip. Counsel must confirm jurisdiction-specific wording.

Last updated: 20 September 2026

Lockup: EVIDENCE ROOM — AP AGENT OS

If this Disclaimer conflicts with a marketing sentence, **this Disclaimer controls** and the marketing sentence should be removed.

1. Nature of the product

Evidence Room — AP Agent OS is a **digital method and toolkit**. It contains written architectures, charters, frameworks, and examples to help an organisation **design, govern, and discuss** an Accounts Payable agent layer.

It is **not**:

- software that connects to, posts to, or operates your ERP
 - a payment service, money-transmission service, or bank
 - an audit, assurance, or attestation engagement
 - legal, tax, accounting, or regulatory advice
 - a certification that you meet any law, standard, or control framework
 - a fraud-detection, AML, or sanctions-screening product
 - a guarantee of any financial or operational result
-

2. Outcomes we do not promise

Without limitation, we do **not** promise or guarantee:

- savings, cost reduction, or **ROI**
- **fraud detection**, fraud prevention, or the absence of duplicate or abusive payments
- **regulatory compliance** (including but not limited to SOX, VAT/GST rules, employment, or data-protection law)
- **accounting accuracy** or correct postings
- **autonomous payment safety**
- cycle-time reduction
- “touchless AP” as an operating state
- that any model you later use will be correct

Any number in the materials labelled illustrative, fictional, or Northline Industrials is **not** a benchmark and **not** a target.

3. Payment authority

The method states that **payment authorisation and release remain human**. That is a design rule in a document. It does not itself stop a person or a vendor from wiring a model to a payment file. **You** must implement holds in your systems and policies.

We are not liable for payments you or your agents release.

4. Implementation is yours

You choose vendors, models, prompts, permissions, owners, and whether to commission any agent. You are responsible for testing, sampling, access control, and local policy.

The toolkit cannot see your invoices unless **you** paste them somewhere. Do not paste production data to us.

5. No professional relationship

Using the site or the files does not create an attorney-client, auditor-client, fiduciary, or similar relationship. Blueprint facilitation, if any, is scoped method design, not an audit opinion.

6. Third parties and names

Mentions of ERP or AP vendors are descriptive. No sponsorship or compatibility certification is implied unless a written agreement says so (none at the time of this draft).

We are **not** affiliated with Evidence Room LLC (forensic animation / evidence-room.net). See Trademark notes.

Lemon Squeezy and Stripe are independent. Their MoR and payment terms are theirs.

7. Site content

Resources, charts, and posts are educational and commercial description. They are not advice to buy or refrain from buying any security or to take any tax position.

8. Limitation pointer

Liability, to the extent it can be limited, is addressed in the Terms. **Counsel must write that limit.** Nothing here is an additional warranty.

9. Short footer (site and checkout)

Evidence Room — AP Agent OS is a digital method and toolkit. It is not an ERP, payment service, audit, or compliance certification. It does not detect fraud, authorise payments, or guarantee savings, accuracy, or ROI. You remain responsible for implementation and for all payment decisions.

Counsel checklist

- ☐ Conform to mandatory consumer wording
- ☐ Harmonise with insurance if any
- ☐ Confirm “not advice” is not over-claimed in Blueprint sales calls